

Vector Analysis

Problem 1.1

Problem 1.2

Is the cross product associative?

$$(\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \times \mathbf{C} \stackrel{?}{=} \mathbf{A} \times (\mathbf{B} \times \mathbf{C})$$

Solution:

No, for example set

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{A} &= \hat{x} \\ \mathbf{B} &= \hat{x} \\ \mathbf{C} &= \hat{z}\end{aligned}$$

Then, the left hand side above becomes

$$(\mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{B}) \times \mathbf{C} = (\hat{x} \times \hat{x}) \times \hat{z} = 0$$

while the right hand side is

$$\mathbf{A} \times (\mathbf{B} \times \mathbf{C}) = \hat{x} \times (\hat{x} \times \hat{z}) = \hat{x} \times -\hat{y} = -\hat{z}$$

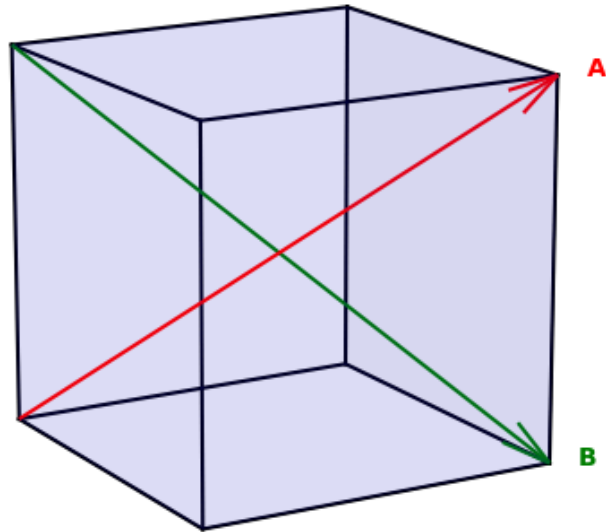
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Problem 1.3

Find the angle between the body diagonals of a cube.

Solution:

The body diagonals $\mathbf{A} = [1, 1, 1]$ and $\mathbf{B} = [1, 1, -1]$



$$|A| = |B| = \sqrt{3}$$

$$A \cdot B = 1 + 1 - 1 = 1$$

$$A \cdot B = |A| |B| \cos \theta = 3 \cos \theta = 1 \rightarrow \theta = \arccos\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) \approx 70.53^\circ \quad \square$$

Problem 1.4

Use the cross product to find the components of the unit vector $\hat{n}$ perpendicular to the shaded plane in Fig.

Solution:

Two of the plane vectors are $v_1 = [-1, 2, 0]$ and $v_2 = [-1, 0, 3]$. $v_1 \times v_2 = n = [6, 3, 2]$ and $|n| = 7$ gives $\hat{n} = \frac{1}{7}[6, 3, 2] \quad \square$

Problem 1.5

Prove the **BAC-CAB** rule,

$$\mathbf{A} \times (\mathbf{B} \times \mathbf{C}) = \mathbf{B}(\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{C}) - \mathbf{C}(\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B})$$

by writing out both sides in component form.

Solution:

Writing out the vectors in component form

$$\mathbf{A} = A_x \hat{\mathbf{x}} + A_y \hat{\mathbf{y}} + A_z \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

$$\mathbf{B} = B_x \hat{\mathbf{x}} + B_y \hat{\mathbf{y}} + B_z \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

$$\mathbf{C} = C_x \hat{\mathbf{x}} + C_y \hat{\mathbf{y}} + C_z \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

starting with lhs

$$\mathbf{B} \times \mathbf{C} = \begin{vmatrix} \hat{\mathbf{x}} & \hat{\mathbf{y}} & \hat{\mathbf{z}} \\ B_x & B_y & B_z \\ C_x & C_y & C_z \end{vmatrix} = (B_y C_z - B_z C_y) \hat{\mathbf{x}} + (B_z C_x - B_x C_z) \hat{\mathbf{y}} + (B_x C_y - B_y C_x) \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

rewriting with a new matrix $\mathbf{D}$ where

$$D_x = B_y C_z - B_z C_y$$

$$D_y = B_z C_x - B_x C_z$$

$$D_z = B_x C_y - B_y C_x$$

gives

$$\mathbf{D} = \mathbf{B} \times \mathbf{C} = D_x \hat{\mathbf{x}} + D_y \hat{\mathbf{y}} + D_z \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

Now

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{A} \times (\mathbf{B} \times \mathbf{C}) &= \mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{D} = \begin{vmatrix} \hat{\mathbf{x}} & \hat{\mathbf{y}} & \hat{\mathbf{z}} \\ A_x & A_y & A_z \\ D_x & D_y & D_z \end{vmatrix} = \\ &= (A_y D_z - A_z D_y) \hat{\mathbf{x}} + (A_z D_x - A_x D_z) \hat{\mathbf{y}} + (A_x D_y - A_y D_x) \hat{\mathbf{z}} \end{aligned}$$

RHS:

$$\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{C} = A_x C_x + A_y C_y + A_z C_z = P$$

$$\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B} = A_x B_x + A_y B_y + A_z B_z = Q$$

$$\mathbf{B}(\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{C}) = B_x P \hat{\mathbf{x}} + B_y P \hat{\mathbf{y}} + B_z P \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

$$\mathbf{C}(\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B}) = C_x Q \hat{\mathbf{x}} + C_y Q \hat{\mathbf{y}} + C_z Q \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

$$\mathbf{B}(\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{C}) - \mathbf{C}(\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B}) = (B_x P - C_x Q) \hat{\mathbf{x}} + (B_y P - C_y Q) \hat{\mathbf{y}} + (B_z P - C_z Q) \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

Now final step is checking if

$$\mathbf{1:} \quad A_y D_z - A_z D_y = B_x P - C_x Q$$

$$\mathbf{2:} \quad A_z D_x - A_x D_z = B_y P - C_y Q$$

$$\mathbf{3:} \quad A_x D_y - A_y D_x = B_z P - C_z Q$$

For **1**:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{LHS: } & A_y(B_x C_y - B_y C_x) - A_z(B_z C_x - B_x C_z) \\ &= A_y B_x C_y - A_y B_y C_x - A_z B_z C_x + A_z B_x C_z \\ &= B_x(A_y C_y + A_z C_z) - C_x(A_y B_y + A_z B_z) \\ \text{RHS: } & B_x(A_x C_x + A_y C_y + A_z C_z) - C_x(A_x B_x + A_y B_y + A_z B_z) \\ &= B_x A_x C_x + B_x(A_y C_y + A_z C_z) - C_x A_x B_x - C_x(A_y B_y + A_z B_z) \\ &= B_x(A_y C_y + A_z C_z) - C_x(A_y B_y + A_z B_z) = \text{LHS } \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

For **2**:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{LHS: } & A_z(B_y C_z - B_z C_y) - A_x(B_x C_y - B_y C_x) \\ &= A_z B_y C_z - A_z B_z C_y - A_x B_x C_y + A_x B_y C_x \\ &= B_y(A_z C_z + A_x C_x) - C_y(A_z B_z + A_x B_x) \\ \text{RHS: } & B_y(A_x C_x + A_y C_y + A_z C_z) - C_y(A_x B_x + A_y B_y + A_z B_z) \\ &= B_y A_y C_y + B_y(A_x C_x + A_z C_z) - C_y A_y B_y - C_y(A_x B_x + A_z B_z) \\ &= B_y(A_x C_x + A_z C_z) - C_y(A_x B_x + A_z B_z) = \text{LHS } \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

For **3**:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{LHS: } & A_x(B_z C_x - B_x C_z) - A_y(B_y C_z - B_z C_y) \\ &= A_x B_z C_x - A_x B_x C_z - A_y B_y C_z + A_y B_z C_y \\ &= B_z(A_x C_x + A_y C_y) - C_z(A_x B_x + A_y B_y) \\ \text{RHS: } & B_z(A_x C_x + A_y C_y + A_z C_z) - C_z(A_x B_x + A_y B_y + A_z B_z) \\ &= B_z A_z C_z + B_z(A_x C_x + A_y C_y) - C_z A_z B_z - C_z(A_x B_x + A_y B_y) \\ &= B_z(A_x C_x + A_y C_y) - C_z(A_x B_x + A_y B_y) = \text{LHS } \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

Since all three components are equal, the BAC-CAB rule is proven. $\square$

Problem 1.6**Problem 1.7****Problem 1.8****Problem 1.9****Problem 1.10****Problem 1.11**

Find the gradients of the following functions:

- (a) $f(x, y, z) = x^2 + y^3 + z^4$
- (b) $f(x, y, z) = x^2 y^3 z^4$
- (c) $f(x, y, z) = e^x \sin(y) \ln(z)$

Solution:

The gradient of a function T is defined as

$$\nabla T = \frac{\partial T}{\partial x} \hat{x} + \frac{\partial T}{\partial y} \hat{y} + \frac{\partial T}{\partial z} \hat{z}$$

This results in

- (a) $2x\hat{x} + 3y^2\hat{y} + 4z^3\hat{z}$
- (b) $2xy^3z^4\hat{x} + 3x^2y^2z^4\hat{y} + 4x^2y^3z^3\hat{z}$
- (c) $e^x \left(\sin(y) \ln(z) \hat{x} + \cos(y) \ln(z) \hat{y} + \frac{\sin(y)}{z} \hat{z} \right)$

□

Problem 1.12

The height of a certain hill (in feet) is given by

$$h(x, y) = 10(2xy - 3x^2 - 4y^2 - 18x + 28y + 12)$$

where y is the distance (in miles) north, x the distance east, of South Hadley.

- (a) Where is the top of the hill located?
- (b) How high is the hill?
- (c) How steep is the slope (in feet per mile) at a point 1 mile north and 1 mile east of South Hadley? In what direction is the slope steepest, at that point?

Solution:

The gradient of $h(x, y)$ is

$$\nabla h = (20y - 60x - 180)\hat{x} + (20x - 80y + 280)\hat{y}$$

- (a) The location of the top is calculated by setting the gradient to 0. This means

$$20y - 60x - 180 = 0$$

$$20x - 80y + 280 = 0$$

which has the solution $(x, y) = (-2, 3)$ miles.

- (b) Putting the values given by (a) into the height function $h(x, y)$, the height of the hill is $h(-2, 3) = 720$ ft.

- (c) At the point $(x, y) = (1, 1)$, the steepness and direction is obtained by putting this point into the gradient. The slope is then $\sqrt{2} \cdot 220$ ft/mile in the direction $-\hat{x} + \hat{y}$, which corresponds to northwest. $\square$

Problem 1.13

Problem 1.14

Problem 1.15

Calculate the divergence of the following vector functions:

- (a) $\mathbf{v}_a = x^2\hat{x} + 3xz^2\hat{y} - 2xz\hat{z}$

- (b) $\mathbf{v}_b = xy\hat{x} + 2yz\hat{y} + 3xz\hat{z}$

- (c) $\mathbf{v}_c = y^2\hat{x} + (2xy + z^2)\hat{y} + 2yz\hat{z}$

Solution:

The divergence of a vector $\mathbf{v}$ is defined as

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} = \frac{\partial v_x}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial v_y}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial v_z}{\partial z}$$

$$(a) \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}_a = 2x - 2x = 0$$

$$(b) \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}_b = y + 2z + 3x$$

$$(c) \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}_c = 2x + 2y$$

□

Problem 1.16

Sketch the vector function

$$\mathbf{v} = \frac{\hat{\mathbf{r}}}{r^2},$$

and compute its divergence.

Solution:

The divergence of the r-component in spherical coordinates is

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} = \frac{1}{r^2} \frac{\partial}{\partial r} (r^2 v_r)$$

Using this, the divergence is $\nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} = 0$. From the sketch, clearly the divergence is not 0 at the origin. The problem arises at the point $\mathbf{r} = 0$ where $\mathbf{v} \rightarrow \infty$. At all other points $\mathbf{r} \neq 0$, the divergence is 0.

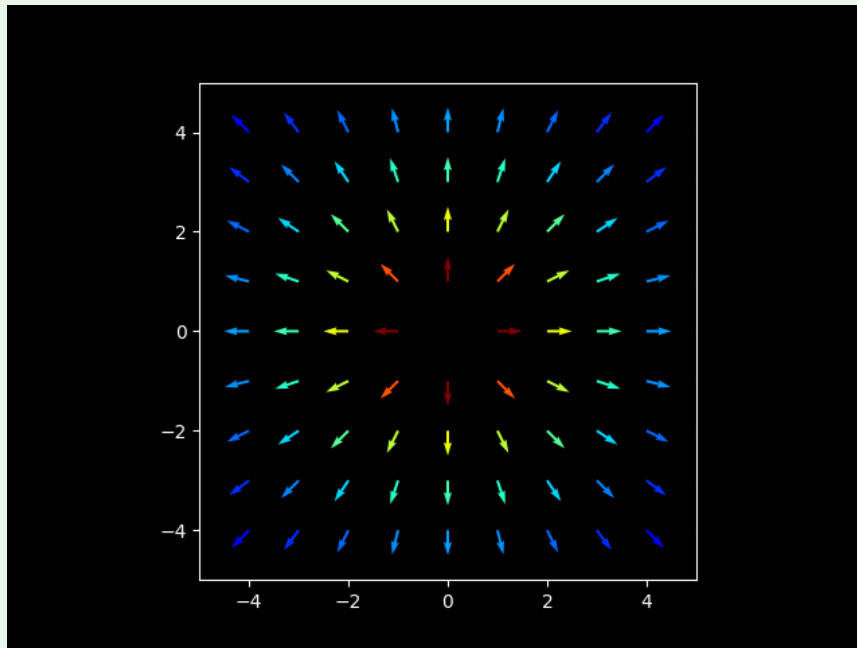


Figure 2: Sketch of the function $\mathbf{v} = \frac{\hat{r}}{r^2}$

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Problem 1.17**Problem 1.18****Problem 1.19****Problem 1.20****Problem 1.21****Problem 1.22****Problem 1.23****Problem 1.24****Problem 1.25****Problem 1.26**

Calculate the Laplacian of the following functions:

(a) $T_a = x^2 + 2xy + 3z + 4$

(b) $T_b = \sin x \sin y \sin z$

(c) $T_c = e^{-5x} \sin 4y \cos 3z$

(d) $\mathbf{v} = x^2 \hat{\mathbf{x}} + 3xz^2 \hat{\mathbf{y}} - 2xz \hat{\mathbf{z}}$

Solution:

The Laplacian of a function T is defined as

$$\nabla^2 T = \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial z^2}$$

and the Laplacian of a vector $\mathbf{v}$ is defined as

$$\nabla^2 \mathbf{v} = (\nabla^2 v_x) \hat{\mathbf{x}} + (\nabla^2 v_y) \hat{\mathbf{y}} + (\nabla^2 v_z) \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

Using this, the result is

(a) $\nabla^2 T_a = 2$

(b) $\nabla^2 T_b = -3 \sin x \sin y \sin z$

(c) $\nabla^2 T_c = e^{-5x} \sin 4y \cos 3z (25 - 16 - 9) = 0$

(d) $\nabla^2 \mathbf{v} = 2\hat{\mathbf{x}} + 6x\hat{\mathbf{y}}$

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Problem 1.27

Problem 1.28

Problem 1.29

Problem 1.30

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